

Gaga Over Broadband

It's official! By the end of 2007, a little over one in two Americans will be surfing at breakneck speeds at home. With 55 per cent of US citizens and 49 per cent of Brits using broadband, one is left wondering when we Indians will read news reports like that. Read our cover story for more...



As One...

...was the name of a meeting held at San Francisco for popular YouTube stars. Publicity stunt? The Web-celebs gathered and posed for camera flashes, handycams and cell phones. Will YouTube be the next TV? Millions across the globe watching millions of videos on the site might agree...



Enter

Suman Ranganathan Actress

Duskily-good-looking-model-turned-actress Suman Ranganathan became a hot topic with the movie "Fareb", following up with movies like "Ishq Qayamat," "Aa ab laut chalen," and "Baghban." She has also starred in several Tamil films. Though she didn't tell us this, we spotted something on the Internet about her being a "deeply religious soul."

So what is technology to you?

I think it is the future. I believe that technology has positives and negatives in life and one needs to take the positive aspects. From the last 30 years, there have been rapid technological changes.

What are the gadgets you use?

I am not a gadget freak at all. However, since I enjoy photography, I will soon be buying a digital camera.

What do you mostly do when you go online?

I just browse around. Play games like Solitaire. Otherwise, nothing much.

Any instance where technology has come to your rescue?

There have been many instances where technology has come to my rescue and many a time it has been my mobile phone.

BETTER XP-ERIENCES

Vista Vs. XP For Gamers

Ever since the launch of Microsoft's latest operating system, Windows Vista, confusion has reigned on the Web. Since it's mostly gamers who are the early adopters of the latest hardware and OS upgrades, it's no surprise that Windows Vista is on every gamer's mind. "Should I switch, or should I ditch the idea?" seems to be the question. And the answers are not hard to come by. Quite the reverse, actually; there are just too many answers at this point in time, and all of them contradicting each other in some way or the other.

It's obvious that no previous operating system from the Microsoft stables has generated quite so much buzz—whether it's Apple fans crying foul for the alleged "copying" of Mac OS X's prettiness, or Windows fanatics raving about Aero, to confused PC gamers standing in the corner shaking their heads at all the commotion while console gamers happily ignore everyone and everything as they rejoice with their Xbox 360s and PS3s!

Respected geek sites—Extreme Tech, Tom's Hardware and the likes—have done every Vista review possible, including

benchmarking the performance differences between a clean Vista install vs. an upgrade from Windows XP. Incidentally, an upgrade from Windows XP seems to be better for

telling gamers *not* to upgrade to Windows Vista? Keeping up the confusion that reigns, we'll say yes and no! For some of you the answer is Yes, don't upgrade; for a smaller number it's No, upgrade immediately, and for the majority... well... we just don't know, and you'll have to make up your own minds.

Here in India, when it comes to gaming, hardware demographics are a little more of a complicated affair. The majority of computer owners have aging hardware that has no right to be running even Windows XP, leave alone Vista. It's very obvious that if those users upgrade to Vista, they'll have to deal with really slow PCs. Those with better hardware are seldom gamers.

Now we come to the PC gamers segment, which again is broken into two segments: the first and larger segment comprises of computers that have pretty decent configurations—an equivalent of an Athlon64 or Pentium D, 1 GB of DDR RAM, and a good DirectX 9 graphics card with 256 MB of RAM. The second and smallest section of the public is the hard core gamers with top-of-the-line hardware—Core 2 Duo/AM2, gigabytes of RAM, and the

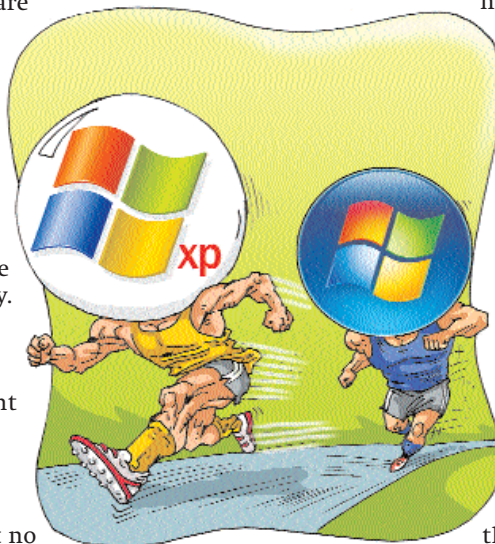


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

gaming than a clean install of Vista, according to benchmarks.

Facts remain facts, however, and currently, Windows XP is slightly ahead in terms of performance for most games. This may be because those games were built for Windows XP, or just the fact that Windows XP has lower hardware requirements, but the message is clear; if you want the best performance you can eke out of your hardware for current generation games, stick to Windows XP!

So that's it? Are we